



FSMA Exemption Calculator A Walkthrough for Farmers

Find out where your farm stands under the FDA Produce Safety Rule — and walk away with the signed record that proves it.

Why this tool exists

If you grow and sell produce, the FDA's Food Safety Modernization Act (FSMA) Produce Safety Rule applies to you — unless your farm is small enough or local enough to be exempt. Most small farms *are* exempt. The catch is that the exemption isn't automatic paperwork-free: the thresholds change every year with inflation, the math uses a three-year rolling average, and if you claim a qualified exemption you're required to keep a written record showing you checked your eligibility annually.

This calculator handles all of that. You type in three years of sales numbers, it tells you exactly where you stand using the FDA's current thresholds, and it produces a signed, citation-backed record you can hand to an inspector. The whole thing takes about ten minutes.

Before you start, gather: your gross sales figures for the last three years (your Schedule F or farm tax records are a good source), broken into produce sales, total food sales, and sales made directly to consumers or local buyers. Estimates get you a preview; exact figures make your printed record solid.

1 Tell it about your farm

Open the app and fill in your farm's name, address, and contact details. This information appears on your printed exemption record, so use your farm's legal name — the one on your tax filings.

Everything you type is **saved automatically on your own device**. Nothing is uploaded anywhere, there's no account to create, and no one else can see your numbers. If you close the app and come back next week, your information is still there.

 **Practical Farm Tools**
FSMA Exemption Calculator & Records Builder

Updated 2026-06-10

Saved Locally

1 Farm Information

Enter your farm's details. This information is saved automatically on your device and will appear on your official exemption record printed for the inspector.

Farm Legal Name

Stone Barn Farm

Farm Physical Address

142 River Road, Skowhegan, ME 04976

Owner/Operator Name

Sarah Brackett

Phone Number

207-555-0142

Farm State

Maine (ME)

Email Address

sarah@stonebarnfarm.me

2 Sales Records & Averages

Select the year you want to claim your exemption for. Then enter your gross sales for the preceding three years. All sales figures are saved automatically as you type. **Tip:** Enter 0 for a year your farm operated but had no sales; leave a year blank only if your farm was not yet in business that year.

Claiming Exemption for Year:

2026 (Uses 2023 - 2025 records)

3 Your Exemption Status

CALCULATED STATUS

Fully Exempt (Produce Sales ≤ \$34,324)

Your farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule because your rolling average produce sales (\$21,500) do not exceed the FDA's inflation-adjusted limit of \$34,324. You do not need to comply with the general requirements of the Produce Safety Rule.

3-Year Rolling Averages

Produce Sales Avg:	\$21,500
Full Exemption Limit:	\$34,324
Total Food Sales Avg:	\$36,500
Qualified Exemption Limit:	\$686,476
Local Sales %:	87%
Required Local %:	> 50%

Action Steps to Prove Exemption:

1. Click **Print / Save Exemption Record** below to generate your record.

2. Sign and date the printed declaration.

3. File this record with your supporting 3-year crop sales logs (retain for at least 3 years).

Your exemption status updates live in the right-hand panel as you type.

2 Enter three years of sales

This is the heart of it. For each of the three years shown, enter three numbers:

- **Gross Produce Sales** — raw fruits, vegetables, herbs, sprouts, nuts, and mushrooms. Leave out hay, meat, dairy, grains, and anything processed.
- **Total Food Sales** — everything you sell that people or animals eat: produce, meat, dairy, eggs, grain, hay. Leave out non-food items like timber, wool, or ornamental plants.
- **Qualified End-User Sales** — food sold directly to consumers (farmstand, farmers' market, CSA, online direct sales) or to restaurants and stores in your state or within 275 miles.

New farm? Enter **0** for a year you operated but had no sales, and leave a year blank only if you weren't in business yet — the calculator adjusts the average accordingly.



2 Sales Records & Averages

Select the year you want to claim your exemption for. Then enter your gross sales for the preceding three years. All sales figures are saved automatically as you type. **Tip:** Enter 0 for a year your farm operated but had no sales; leave a year blank only if your farm was not yet in business that year.

Claiming Exemption for Year:

2026 (Uses 2023 - 2025 records)

Year	Gross Produce Sales Raw fruits, veggies, herbs, nuts, mushrooms. Exclude hay, meat, dairy, grains, processed foods.	Total Food Sales All human food + animal feed. Must include produce, meat, dairy, eggs, grains, hay. Exclude wood, wool.	Qualified End-User Sales Sales directly to consumers (CSA, stand, market) or local stores/restaurants in-state or < 275 miles.
2023	\$ 18500	\$ 32000	\$ 28000
2024	\$ 21200	\$ 36500	\$ 31000
2025	\$ 24800	\$ 41000	\$ 36000

Future Year Exemption Planner (Optional)

Local Sales %:

87%

Required Local %:

> 50%

Action Steps to Prove Exemption:

1. Click **Print / Save Exemption Record** below to generate your record.
2. Sign and date the printed declaration.
3. File this record with your supporting 3-year crop sales logs (retain for at least 3 years).

Preview Exemption Letter

Print / Save Exemption Record

Produce Safety Rule Exemption Criteria

Fully Exempt (Not Covered) — 21 CFR § 112.4(a)

A farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule if their average annual produce sales over the preceding 3 years is **\$34,324 or less** (the FDA inflation-adjusted threshold for 2026).

Partially Exempt (Qualified Exemption) — 21 CFR § 112.5

A farm qualifies for a Qualified Exemption if:

1. Average annual total food sales over the preceding 3 years is less than the inflation-adjusted threshold (**\$686,476** for 2026).
2. Sales to "qualified end-users" (consumers anywhere, or restaurants/retail food establishments in the same state, on the same Indian reservation, or within 275 miles) exceeds sales to all other buyers combined.

Exemption Recordkeeping & Bookkeeping Guidelines

To verify compliance for an inspector using your farm records:

- **Gross Produce Sales:** All sales of raw, fresh agricultural produce

Each column explains what to include and what to leave out, right where you need it.

3 Read your result

The status panel does the math the same way the FDA does — a three-year rolling average compared against the current inflation-adjusted thresholds — and gives you one of three answers, each with a plain-language explanation of what it means and what to do next:

Status	What it means
Fully Exempt	Your average produce sales are at or below the FDA threshold (\$34,324 for 2026). The Produce Safety Rule doesn't cover your farm. Keep sales records on file to show it.
Partially Exempt (Qualified)	Your food sales are under the limit (\$686,476 for 2026) and most of them go to local buyers. You skip the rule's general requirements but must label your products with your farm name and address, and keep an annual written eligibility record — which this app prints for you.
Not Exempt	Your farm is fully covered by the rule. The app explains exactly which threshold you crossed, so there's no guesswork about why.



1 Farm Information

Enter your farm's details. This information is saved automatically on your device and will appear on your official exemption record printed for the inspector.

Farm Legal Name

Stone Barn Farm

Farm Physical Address

142 River Road, Skowhegan, ME 04976

Owner/Operator Name

Sarah Brackett

Phone Number

207-555-0142

Farm State

Maine (ME)

Email Address

sarah@stonebarnfarm.me

2 Sales Records & Averages

Select the year you want to claim your exemption for. Then enter your gross sales for the preceding three years. All sales figures are saved automatically as you type. **Tip:** Enter 0 for a year your farm operated but had no sales; leave a year blank only if your farm was not yet in business that year.

Claiming Exemption for Year:

2026 (Uses 2023 - 2025 records)

3 Your Exemption Status

CALCULATED STATUS

Partially Exempt (Qualified Local Farm)

Your farm qualifies for a Qualified Exemption (partial exemption). Your average total food sales (\$160,000) are below the FDA inflation-adjusted limit of \$686,476, and the majority of your food sales (72%) are sold directly to qualified end-users (local consumers, stores, or restaurants). You must comply with modified requirements under 21 CFR §§ 112.6 and 112.7.

3-Year Rolling Averages

Produce Sales Avg: **\$65,000**
Full Exemption Limit: \$34,324

Total Food Sales Avg: **\$160,000**
Qualified Exemption Limit: \$686,476

Local Sales %: **72%**
Required Local %: > 50%

Action Steps to Secure Qualified Exemption:

1. Click **Print / Save Exemption Record** below to generate your record.
2. Sign and date the printed annual written determination.
3. File it alongside your sales logs or farm records (retain for at least 3

A qualified exemption result. The panel shows your averages next to each FDA limit and lists the exact steps to secure your status.

4 Print your record

Once your farm name and your sales numbers are in, the **Preview Exemption Letter** and **Print / Save Exemption Record** buttons unlock. The document it generates isn't a generic printout — it's a formal annual determination with your sales ledger, the three-year math shown line by line, the specific federal regulations that apply to your status, and a signature block.

Exemption Document Preview

Print Document

Close Preview



Annual Exemption Documentation | FSMA Produce Safety Rule (21 CFR Part 112)

ANNUAL DETERMINATION OF NON-
COVERAGE STATUS (21 CFR § 112.4(a))

FARM PROFILE

Farm Legal Name: Stone Barn Farm
Physical Address: 142 River Road, Skowhegan, ME 04976
Owner / Operator: Sarah Brackett
Contact Details: 207-555-0142 | sarah@stonebarnfarm.me

RECORD DETAILS

Assessment Year: 2026
Calculation Date: June 12, 2026
FDA Threshold Update: 2026-06-10
Status: **FULLY EXEMPT**
(PRODUCE SALES ≤ \$34,324)

FULLY EXEMPT (PRODUCE SALES ≤ \$34,324)

Your farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule because your rolling average produce sales (\$21,500) do not exceed the FDA's inflation-adjusted limit of \$34,324. You do not need to comply with the general requirements of the Produce Safety Rule.

3-YEAR SALES LEDGER & MATH EXPLANATION

ASSESSMENT YEAR	GROSS PRODUCE SALES (\$)	GROSS TOTAL FOOD SALES (\$)	QUALIFIED END-USER SALES (\$)	QUALIFIED END-USER %
2023	\$18,500	\$32,000	\$28,000	88%
2024	\$21,200	\$36,500	\$31,000	85%
2025	\$21,000	\$41,000	\$38,000	93%

Preview the document on screen before printing.

Sign it, date it, and file it with your sales records. If an inspector ever asks how you determined your exemption status, you hand them this.

Exemption Document Preview

[Print Document](#)[Close Preview](#)

2024	\$21,200	\$36,500	\$31,000	85%
2025	\$24,800	\$41,000	\$36,000	88%
3-Year Average	\$21,500	\$36,500	\$31,667	87%
FDA Inflation Threshold	\$34,324	\$686,476	N/A	> 50% Required

APPLICABLE REGULATORY CITATIONS

Legal Citation: 21 CFR § 112.4(a) — A farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule if its average annual value of produce sold during the previous 3-year period does not exceed \$25,000 (adjusted for inflation: \$34,324 for the 2026 claim year).

Recordkeeping Best Practice: Although not covered by the rule, you should retain your yearly tax returns and crop sales records for at least 3 years to document and verify your exempt status during audits or inspections.

COMPLIANCE DECLARATION

I hereby certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of Maine and the United States of America that the gross sales figures and distribution percentages detailed above are true, accurate, and correct representations of our farm's financial records. Supporting documentation (tax records, invoices, sales ledger receipts) is maintained at our farm headquarters and will be retained for as long as necessary to support our farm's status, and no less than 2 years, in accordance with 21 CFR § 112.164. These records will be made readily available to FDA or State of Maine officials for inspection and copying upon request in accordance with 21 CFR § 112.166; any records stored offsite will be retrieved and provided within 24 hours of request per 21 CFR § 112.162(a).

CERTIFIED OWNER/OPERATOR
SIGNATURE

PRINTED NAME & TITLE

DATE SIGNED

This verification document was generated in accordance with the FDA FSMA Produce Safety Rule (21 CFR Part 112) guidelines. The inflation-adjusted values shown are derived from the official FDA database using Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Implicit Price Deflators.

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Exemption Certification
Service | fma-exempt-
v1.0

Every record includes the exact regulatory citations and a compliance declaration ready for your signature.

Tip: in the print dialog, choose "Save as PDF" instead of a printer to keep a digital copy alongside the paper one.

5 Optional: look ahead to next year

Wondering whether a good season could push you over a threshold? Open the **Future Year Exemption Planner**, enter what you expect to sell this year, and it projects next year's status using your existing records plus your estimate. Useful when you're deciding whether to expand a crop, take on a wholesale account, or start preparing for full coverage ahead of time.



2024	\$ 21200	\$ 36500	\$ 31000
2025	\$ 24800	\$ 41000	\$ 36000

Future Year Exemption Planner (Optional)

Plan ahead for next year (2027). This tool pre-populates your records from Step 2 and lets you enter projected sales for the current year to predict your future exemption status.

Projected Current Year: 2026

Projected Gross Produce Sales

\$ 26000

Projected Total Food Sales

\$ 45000

Projected Qualified End-User Sales

\$ 40000

PROJECTED EXEMPTION STATUS

Projected Exempt

Based on projections, your estimated rolling average produce sales (\$24,000) remain below the \$34,324 threshold. Your farm would remain **Fully Exempt** next year.

 **Exemption Math:** Next year's assessment will average your sales from 2024, 2025, and 2026 (Projected). Projections are compared against the latest 2026 thresholds as a baseline estimate. Next year's official limits will adjust slightly for inflation when FDA publishes updated cut-offs each spring.

Produce Safety Rule Exemption Criteria

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A farm qualifies for a Qualified Exemption if:

1. Average annual total food sales over the preceding 3 years is less than the inflation-adjusted threshold (**\$686,476** for 2026).
2. Sales to "qualified end-users" (consumers anywhere, or restaurants/retail food establishments in the same state, on the same Indian reservation, or within 275 miles) exceeds sales to all other buyers combined.

Exemption Recordkeeping & Bookkeeping Guidelines

To verify compliance for an inspector using your farm records:

- **Gross Produce Sales:** All sales of raw, fresh agricultural produce (fruits, vegetables, herbs, sprouts, nuts). Do not include sales of non-produce products like livestock, poultry, dairy, grain, or hay.
- **Total Food Sales:** All sales of food products for human or animal consumption. This includes raw produce, processed food, meat, dairy, eggs, grain, and livestock feed (such as hay/silage). Subtract non-food items like timber, wool, ornamental plants, or flowers.
- **Qualified End-User Sales:** Sales of food products directly to the consumer (via CSA, farmers' markets, farmstands, online direct sales) or to local restaurants or retail food establishments located in the same state/territory or within 275 miles.

 **Recordkeeping Requirement:** Farms claiming a Qualified Exemption MUST establish and keep a written record reflecting that an annual eligibility review was performed (21 CFR § 112.7). Records must be readily available for FDA inspection (21 CFR § 112.166); records stored offsite must be retrievable within 24 hours of request (21 CFR § 112.162(a)). Fully exempt farms should also keep sales records to document their non-covered status.

Enter projected sales for the current year and see where next year is likely to land.

A few things worth knowing

- **It works without a signal.** Once you've opened the app on your phone or computer, it keeps working with no internet at all — in the barn, in the field, anywhere. Add it to your home screen and it behaves like a regular app.
- **The numbers stay current.** The dollar thresholds come straight from the FDA's official inflation-adjusted cut-offs, which are updated each spring. The app shows the date of its threshold data right in the header, so you always know what it's working from.
- **Your data stays yours.** Sales figures never leave your device. There's no account, no sign-up, and nothing for anyone to look at but you.
- **It's free.** No trial, no upsell.

This tool is provided to help farms understand and document their status under the FSMA Produce Safety Rule (21 CFR Part 112). It is not legal advice. If your operation is complex or sits close to a

threshold, it's worth a conversation with your state produce safety program or extension office — in Maine, that's the Maine Department of Agriculture, Conservation and Forestry.

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